

Question 4:-

Explain the role of Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS) System and Surge Protection in preventing file system corruption and ensuring data integrity during unexpected power fluctuations.

Role of Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS) Systems and Surge Protection

A **UPS (Uninterruptible Power Supply)** and **surge protection device** help protect computers and electronic equipment from unexpected power problems. They play a vital role in **preventing file system corruption** and **ensuring data integrity** during power outages, voltage fluctuations, and electrical surges.

1. Role of an Uninterruptible Power Supply (UPS)

A UPS is a backup power device that supplies electricity from its battery when the main power source fails.

Functions of a UPS

- Provides temporary backup power during power outages.
- Allows users enough time to save open files and shut down the computer safely.
- Prevents sudden system shutdowns that can damage files and operating systems.
- Protects against voltage dips (brownouts) and short power interruptions.
- Maintains continuous operation of critical devices such as servers and networking equipment.

Preventing File System Corruption

A sudden power loss while the operating system is writing data to the storage device can interrupt the write process. This may result in:

- Corrupted files.
- Damaged file allocation tables or file systems.
- Operating system boot failures.
- Loss of unsaved work.

A UPS keeps the system powered long enough for a proper shutdown, reducing the risk of file system corruption.

Ensuring Data Integrity

Data integrity means that data remains **accurate, complete, and unaltered**. A UPS helps maintain data integrity by:-

- Allowing applications to finish writing data to storage.
- Preventing incomplete database transactions.
- Reducing the risk of data loss during unexpected outages.
- Supporting automatic safe shutdown features on servers.

2. Role of Surge Protection

A surge protector protects electronic devices from sudden increases in electrical voltage (power surges).

Functions of Surge Protection

- Absorbs or diverts excess voltage away from connected devices.
- Protects sensitive components such as the motherboard, CPU, RAM, SSD/HDD, and power supply.
- Prevents hardware damage caused by lightning strikes or electrical switching.

Preventing Hardware Damage

Without surge protection, voltage spikes can:

- Damage storage devices.
- Corrupt data being written to disk.
- Destroy system components.
- Reduce the lifespan of electronic equipment.

Surge protectors minimize these risks by blocking excessive voltage before it reaches the computer.

3. Combined Benefits of UPS and Surge Protection

Feature	UPS	Surge Protector
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Backup power during outages	✓	✗
Safe system shutdown	✓	✗
Protection from voltage spikes	Some models	✓
Prevents file system corruption	✓	Indirectly
Protects hardware components	✓	✓
Maintains data integrity	✓	✓

Example Scenario

A company employee is editing an important project report while a database is saving files.

- **Without a UPS:** A sudden power outage immediately shuts down the computer. Unsaved work is lost, and the file system may become corrupted because the write operation was interrupted.
- **With a UPS:** The computer continues running on battery power, allowing the employee to save the report and shut down safely, preserving both the file system and the data.
- **With surge protection:** If a voltage spike occurs during a thunderstorm, the surge protector prevents excess voltage from damaging the computer's hardware.